

Delivery Providers Mapping & Rating — Morocco

Building a national reference database of delivery companies, branch by branch, based on real customer reviews

Scope	Morocco — all cities covered by e-commerce delivery providers
Project type	Data Engineering — collection, structuring & analysis of data
Main deliverable	Ranked database: provider → branch/location → average rating → review count → rank
Status	Initial scoping
Team	Abdelhamid, Hibat Allah

1. Context & Why It Matters

In e-commerce, product and price aren't enough to build trust — delivery is the real physical touchpoint between seller and buyer. It's the one moment in the transaction where the customer actually meets the company: through the courier, the delay, the state of the package, and how cash-on-delivery (COD) payment is handled.

A bad delivery experience (late arrival, damaged package, delayed COD remittance, unreachable courier) instantly destroys the trust that marketing and customer service built beforehand. Conversely, reliable delivery becomes a genuine loyalty driver. Choosing a delivery provider is therefore not a minor logistics detail — it's a strategic decision that directly impacts customer satisfaction, return rates, and seller reputation.

The Moroccan delivery market is fragmented: dozens of providers (Amana, Ozon Express, Cathedis, Sendit, Infinidis, Forcelog, High Delivery, etc.) operate local branch networks across different cities, and service quality varies significantly from one branch to another within the same provider. Existing rankings (blogs, directories) are often biased or sponsored, and Google/Facebook reviews are scattered, unstructured, and sometimes manipulated (fake reviews).

This project builds a reliable, usable database, branch by branch, enabling an objective comparison of providers across Morocco.

2. Objectives

- Build a comprehensive reference list of active delivery providers in Morocco and their branches/locations.
- Collect, for each branch, the average rating and review count.
- Produce an ordered ranking of providers, best to worst rated, both by city and nationally.
- Deliver a structured, reusable dataset, updated periodically.

Scoping note: in this first version, data is collected and ranked as-is (average rating + review count), with no fake-review detection step. This limitation is deliberate and documented in Section 5.

3. Project Description

The pipeline has four stages: collection, cleaning/scoring, storage, and delivery. Each provider is treated as a parent entity linked to one or more locations (branches), each carrying its own rating and reviews — mirroring reality on the ground (e.g. Ozon Express Casablanca ≠ Ozon Express Marrakech in perceived quality).

3.1 Target Data Model

Simplified version — no collection of individual review text, no anti-fake-review scoring. Only average rating and review count are kept per branch.

Entity	Main attributes
Provider	id, name, sector (e-commerce / food / B2B), cities covered, website
Branch / Location	id, provider_id, city, address, latitude, longitude
Rating	branch_id, average_rating, review_count, extraction_date, rank

3.2 Data Sources

- Google Maps / Google Business listings per branch (rating, review count, review text)
- Provider Facebook pages (reviews and recommendations, often more qualitative)
- Moroccan sector directories (Shipper.ma, SwiftLog.ma) — provider lists and ranking cross-checks
- Supplementary sources: Trustpilot, mobile app store reviews (where a provider has a tracking app)

3.3 Collection Method

Collection will rely on a structured Google Maps scraping tool (e.g. Outscraper / Apify), queried with a combined list of {provider name} × {city}, rather than manual scraping of Google pages — to make collection more reliable and limit risk related to Google's terms of use.

A slower but risk-free alternative: automatically generating search queries/URLs, then a human operator semi-manually records ratings for the most strategic branches.

For each branch, only two raw values are kept, exactly as returned by the source: average rating and total review count. No reprocessing or filtering of review content is done at this stage.

3.4 Ranking Logic

- Branches sorted by descending average rating, regardless of review volume — no weighting by review count in this version.
- Optional aggregation at provider level (average across branches) for a national company-level ranking.
- Filterable view by city for local rankings.

3.5 Storage & Delivery

- Structured file (CSV) or lightweight database (SQLite), one row per branch: provider, city, rating, review count, rank.
- Sorted export, best to worst rated, directly usable in a spreadsheet.
- Periodic refresh (e.g. quarterly) to track rating changes over time.

4. Project Timeline

Step	Content	Deliverable
1. Scoping	List of target providers and cities, choice of collection tool	Search list (provider × city)
2. Collection	Extraction of average rating, review count and location per branch	Raw dataset
3. Normalization	Deduplication, harmonization of city and provider names	Cleaned dataset
4. Ranking	Descending sort by rating, aggregation by provider and by city	Ranked database
5. Delivery	Final sorted export (CSV / spreadsheet)	Final deliverable

5. Risks & Points of Vigilance

Terms of use: direct Google Maps scraping violates its ToS; prioritize third-party scraping providers or the official API to limit risk.

Fake reviews (accepted limitation): no detection is performed in this version. Displayed ratings may be artificially inflated for branches that incentivize positive reviews. The ranking should be read as a raw indicator, not an absolute measure of service quality.

Data freshness: a branch's service quality can change quickly (management change, demand surges) — regular updates are needed.

Incomplete coverage: some small rural branches have no Google Maps listing or reviews — these areas remain blind spots in the dataset.

Unweighted review volume: a branch with 5★ from 2 reviews will rank the same as one with 5★ from 500 reviews under a simple rating sort — worth keeping in mind when reading the ranking.

6. Expected Value

This reference database will let Moroccan e-merchants choose their delivery provider based on objective data rather than word-of-mouth or sponsored rankings — reducing return rates, securing COD remittance timelines, and ultimately improving the purchase experience for their own customers.